

What to do next

Notice 2: 8 U.S.C. § 1815 — Fee for being apprehended between ports of entry (F26-778899)

Your deadline

Your papers must be **sent by Tuesday, October 20, 2026**. That is 30 days from the date on the notice. Do not wait until the last day.

- Deadlines are counted from the date printed on the notice, even if it reached you late. If you are not sure, send your papers right away.

Step by step

Step 1: Read your papers carefully

- Check that your name, A-Number, Fee Tracking Number, dates, and amount are correct.
- Make sure everything is **true**. When you sign, you are promising under **penalty of perjury** (lying is a crime) that it is true.
- If something is wrong, go back in the app, fix it, and download your papers again.

Step 2: Print, sign, and scan

- Print all pages. No printer? Try a public library, a print shop (like FedEx Office, Staples, or The UPS Store), or a community organization.
- Sign with blue or black ink: **the cover letter** (page 1, above your name) and **the written defense** (the “Signature” line on its last page). Write the date next to “Today’s date.”
- The person who translated for you must sign and date the **Certificate of Translation** (the last page).
- Make a PDF of the signed pages with your phone: on iPhone use the **Notes** app (Scan Documents); on Android use **Google Drive** (Scan). Also scan or photograph **every page of your notice**.
- Can’t print? Some free phone apps (such as Adobe Fill & Sign) let you sign a PDF with your finger.

Step 3: Send the email

- Send an email **to: INAfees@cbp.dhs.gov**
- Use the subject line and message the app gives you (you can copy them on the last screen of the app).
- **Attach:** (1) your signed papers and (2) the copy of your notice.
- After you send it, check your “Sent” folder. Take a screenshot of the sent email and keep it. Save any reply you get.

What happens next

- CBP will review your dispute. Check your email often, including your spam or junk folder, and open all mail from DHS right away.

If you get a bill (invoice) later

- **Do not ignore it.** Bills can come from U.S. Customs and Border Protection (CBP), the

Department of the Treasury's Centralized Receivables Service (CRS), or a private debt collector.

- **Bill from CBP:** you can dispute it in writing by email to **INACivilPenalties@cbp.dhs.gov** within **10 calendar days** of the invoice date. Include your Penalty Tracking Number and send these same papers again.
- **Bill from CRS (Treasury):** use the free CRS Dispute Form and cover letter: <https://noimmigrationfines.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/09/6-CRS-Dispute-Form.pdf> and https://noimmigrationfines.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/09/7-CRS-Dispute-Cover-Letter_081925.docx
- **Letter from a private debt collector:** send them a dispute letter right away (sample: <https://library.nclc.org/companion-material/sample-dispute-letter>). The law says they must pause collection when you dispute the debt.
- This app can also make dispute papers for a bill — start a new notice and choose “A bill (invoice) or past-due notice.”

Important to know

- **Should I just pay?** Talk to a lawyer first. DHS may treat payment as admitting that you did something wrong. If you do pay, write **“Payment under protest, with reservation of rights”** on your check or money order.
- **Is it risky to fight the fine?** It is up to DHS to prove the fine is justified. The lawyers at noimmigrationfines.org encourage people to file an opposition and raise their defenses.
- **If you move,** tell ICE (and the immigration court or USCIS, if you have a case there) your new address right away, so you do not miss important letters.

Get help

- Questions and answers about these fines: <https://noimmigrationfines.org/#FAQs>
- Find free or low-cost legal help: <https://www.immigrationadvocates.org/legaldirectory/>